

TEACHING TIPS:

- Talk about the **lyrics** to this song. What is happening to the tadpole?
- Can you make up some **actions** to help remember what happens in each verse?
- The whole song is made up of short one-and-a-half or two-bar phrases, which makes it easy to learn. Teach the song using **call-and-response** and if you use Words on Screen (WOS) then take advantage of the double-click line function.
- Choose a small group of strong singers to do the chorus harmonies. If you can, play or sing through each of the parts individually to help the singers learn their line, or even better, use the WOS which will play each harmony part for you.
- Be prepared for, and enjoy, the backing track 'stop' when you sing the word 'tadpole'.

WHAT YOU NEED

Recording of *Carnival of the Animals*, pictures of orchestral instruments; pitched and unpitched instruments

BRIGHT IDEA

If space allows, can they move around to the music in the style of the animals?

STEP IT UP!

Compose some short animal pieces. In small groups, choose an animal and discuss its characteristics. Will the music be loud or soft, fast or slow, low- or high-pitched, and which instruments will best represent the animal? Use pitched and unpitched percussion, keyboards, or any instruments that you are able to play. Then, encourage the children to imagine they are telling a story in order to give the music a structure. What is happening to the animal? Are they asleep, on the prowl, playing? What will their music need to do to show this? Ask each group to announce their animal to the class before they perform their piece.

TEMPO

The speed of the music

DYNAMICS

Volume

TIMBRE

The character or quality of a musical sound

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 5-7

Many composers have been inspired to write **music about animals**. One of the most famous pieces is *Carnival of the Animals*, a suite for two pianos and orchestral instruments by Camille Saint-Saëns. Discuss the instruments of the orchestra (show some pictures) and then write the list of the movements from this piece up on the board. Play the children a few of them and see if they can guess which animal is represented each time.

What clues are given in the music? Listen out for:

- Whether the music is loud or soft (**dynamics**)
- Which instrumentation the composer has chosen to use – piano, strings, woodwind, brass, percussion? (**timbre**)
- What speed is the music – is it slow or fast? (**tempo**)

For example:

- **The Royal March of the Lion** – the music is loud, proud and stately. About halfway through the piano plays a chromatic scale in the bass (this is then echoed by the lower strings), which is the lions growling!
- **Tortoises** – the music is slow and plodding with the tune in the bass (lower strings).
- **Kangaroos** – The melody 'jumps' around the piano!
- **The Swan** – The gentle broken chords in the piano depict the rippling water with the cello representing the swan gliding serenely through it.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To listen to and identify different timbres and instrumentation.

To create a composition that tells a story, using sound imagery.

To perform as a group.